

You don't need to know how to edit.

You need to know what you want.



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hubeiqiao.com/video-guide

YOUR FIRST HOUR

1 Get Claude Code

Pick Opus 5.5. Medium effort is the default; go higher for better drafts. Codex works too.

2 Add the Skill

Just ask: "Install the make-a-video Skill from github.com/hubeiqiao/how-i-make-videos-with-ai." It installs itself.

3 Say what you want

Put 10 to 30 of your own photos or clips in one folder, open it and send one message.

4 React to your first draft

It sets up Remotion and renders a whole draft from your files. Then write your first note.

YOUR FIRST MESSAGE

Use the make-a-video Skill. Make a 30-second video from the files in this folder. It is for [who will watch]. After watching, they should [believe or do one thing].

THE FIVE STEPS. THE SAME WITH ANY MODEL.

1 Know what you want. Then gather your files.

Yours: What you want, and your real files. No model can invent them.

☐ Done when every part of your outline points to a real file.

2 Get the whole draft once. Then react.

Yours: Judging it. Keep a draft that is roughly right; ask again if it is far off.

☐ Done when a playable video exists from the first word to the last.

3 Point at the problem. Fix one section at a time.

Yours: Watching every round yourself, and deciding when a section is done.

☐ Done when every section has an approved file name and you have nothing left to say.

4 Put it together. Listen at every join.

Yours: Listening at every join, and choosing the music.

☐ Done when you can watch it end to end without wincing once.

5 Finish where people see it. Then save it as a Skill.

Yours: Checking it on a phone, where people will really see it.

☐ Done when the post preview looks right and the Skill is saved.

A USEFUL NOTE HAS FOUR PARTS

Where

What's wrong

What you want

What must stay

NOTE 1 • 0:04

The title is too small. Make it fill the frame. Keep the music.

FOUR THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE TOOL

Know what the video is for. Who watches, and what should they do after? The AI builds it, but the result is yours.

Be patient. Almost nothing good comes out in one shot, even from the best model. Say what's wrong and pull again.

Render one section at a time. A full render is slow. Fix one section, render just that part, check it, move on.

Your taste is the job. The AI can make a hundred versions. Knowing the good one is yours. Watch the best work you can find to train it.

Skill: A note of your rules the AI reads before it starts.